

Word family: **blink / blinks / blinked / blinking / blinker**

Base word: blink

Past tense: blinked

Past participle: blinked

-ing form: blinking

Related form: blinker

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “One summer, my bicycle broke down, and I wanted to get it fixed **in the blink of an eye**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **blink** appears in the fixed expression **in the blink of an eye**, meaning **extremely quickly, in a very short moment**.

The image comes from how quickly a person closes and opens their eyes when they blink.

繁體中文： **一眨眼之間；轉瞬間；極短時間內**

中文翻譯：

> “...I wanted to get it fixed **in the blink of an eye**.”

「.....我只想**一眨眼之間 / 馬上**把單車修好。」

Here:

in the blink of an eye = 快得像眨一次眼睛一樣；轉瞬之間

1. **blink = close and open the eyes quickly (眼睛) — 眨眼**

This is the central literal meaning.

Meaning: To close your eyes and immediately open them again, usually automatically.

Practice 1

> “She **blinked** several times in the bright sunlight.”

「她在強烈陽光下**眨了幾次眼**。」

Practice 2

> “Try not to **blink** while I take the photograph.”

「我拍照時盡量不要**眨眼**。」

blink = 快速閉上眼睛再張開，通常是一種自然反應

Common:

- * blink your eyes
- * blink rapidly
- * blink several times
- * barely blink

2. **a blink** = one quick closing and opening of the eyes (名詞) — 一次眨眼

As a noun, **a blink** is one act of blinking.

Practice 3

> “It happened in a single **blink**.”

「事情就在一次**眨眼**的工夫發生了。」

Practice 4

> “His expression changed with barely a **blink**.”

「他的表情幾乎連**眨一下眼**的時間都沒有便改變了。」

a blink = 一次快速閉眼再張眼的動作

For core counting, I would merge this with Meaning 1 because it is simply the noun form of the same physical action.

3. **blink** = light/device flash on and off repeatedly (燈光 / 裝置) — 閃爍；一明一滅

Blink can also describe a light, signal, cursor, or electronic display repeatedly switching on and off.

Practice 5

> “A red warning light was **blinking**.”

「一盞紅色警告燈正在**閃爍**。」

Practice 6

> “The cursor **blinked** on the screen.”

「游標在螢幕上不斷**閃動**。」

blink = 燈光、訊號或電子顯示反覆快速亮起和熄滅

This is a genuinely distinct non-human sense.

4. **blink** = react with surprise/confusion (反應) — 眨眼表示驚訝 / 困惑

Because blinking can accompany surprise or confusion, **blink** can sometimes imply a visible reaction.

Practice 7

> “He **blinked** in surprise when he heard the news.”

「他聽到消息後驚訝得**眨了眨眼**。」

Practice 8

> “She **blinked** at him, unsure whether he was serious.”

「她困惑地對他**眨了眨眼**，不知道他是不是認真的。」

The physical action is still literal, while the surrounding context tells us the emotion.

For strict database counting, I would **not** create a separate core meaning here. It remains the ordinary eye-action sense.

Target expression: **in the blink of an eye** — 一眨眼間；轉瞬間

This is the exact expression in your passage.

Practice 9 — Original

> “I wanted to get it fixed **in the blink of an eye**.”

「我想**一眨眼之間**就把它修好。」

Practice 10

> “The weekend seemed to disappear **in the blink of an eye**.”

「週末好像**一轉眼**就過去了。」

in the blink of an eye = 在極短時間內；快得像眨一次眼睛一樣

This is a fixed idiom built from the literal eye meaning, not a new core meaning of **blink**.

The Golden Manual says useful fixed expressions should be included where they add learning value, but they should not automatically be counted as separate lexical senses.

Useful expression: **blink first — 先退讓；先示弱**

In a contest of determination, **blink first** figuratively means being the first person to give in.

Practice 11

> “Neither side wanted to **blink first**.”

「雙方都不想**先退讓 / 先示弱**。」

Practice 12

> “He refused to **blink first** during the negotiation.”

「在談判中，他拒絕**率先讓步**。」

The metaphor comes from a staring contest: the first person who blinks appears to have lost.

This is a fixed figurative expression, not another core sense.

Useful expression: **on the blink — 出故障**

This is informal, especially British English.

Practice 13

> “My washing machine is **on the blink** again.”

「我的洗衣機又**壞了 / 出故障了**。」

Practice 14

> “The printer has been **on the blink** all morning.”

「打印機整個早上都在**出故障**。」

on the blink = 機器或設備運作不正常；出故障

This is an idiom and should stay outside the core lexical count.

Related form: **blinker**

Blinker has developed several specialized meanings.

blinker = vehicle turn signal (美式) — 方向燈

Practice 15

> “Use your **blinker** before changing lanes.”

「轉線前要打**方向燈**。」

In American English:

blinker = turn signal / indicator

blinkers = horse eye covers (馬眼罩) — 馬眼罩

Practice 16

> “The horse was wearing **blinkers**.”

「那匹馬戴着**馬眼罩**。」

These limit the horse's side vision and help it focus ahead.

This is a lexical family extension rather than another meaning of bare **blink**.

Important distinction: **blink** vs **wink**

blink

= close and open the eyes quickly, normally both eyes and often involuntarily

wink

= deliberately close and open **one eye**, usually as a signal or playful gesture

> “She blinked because of the dust.”

「她因灰塵而眨眼。」

> “She winked at me.”

「她向我眨一隻眼示意。」

This is an important learner distinction.

Important distinction: **blink** vs **flash**

For lights:

blink

usually means repeatedly turn on and off.

flash

can mean suddenly shine brightly once or repeatedly.

> blinking warning light

= 一明一滅的警告燈

> flash of lightning

= 一道閃光

They overlap, but **blink** strongly suggests an alternating on-off pattern.

Important distinction: **blink** vs **flicker**

blink

usually involves clear repeated on/off changes.

flicker

means light changes unsteadily in brightness, often irregularly.

> blinking cursor

regular on/off pattern.

> flickering candle

不穩定地閃動的燭光。

Family-extension note

The practical modern family is fairly small:

* **blink**

* **blinks**

* **blinked**

* **blinking**

* **blinker**

Useful constructions include:

* blink your eyes

* blinking light

* in the blink of an eye

* blink first

* on the blink

The Golden Manual's family sweep asks us to include useful inflections, derivatives, compounds, and idioms while filtering out unnecessary or obscure extensions.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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blink — eyes	快速閉上眼睛再張開；眨眼
a blink — noun	一次快速閉眼再張眼的動作；與 literal eye sense 相同
blink — light/device	燈光、訊號或電子顯示反覆快速亮起和熄滅；閃爍
in the blink of an eye	在極短時間內；一眨眼間 / 轉瞬間
blink first	在意志或談判較量中率先退讓、示弱
on the blink	機器或設備出故障；非正式
blinker	美式：車輛方向燈；複數 blinkers 亦可指馬眼罩

For your original sentence

> “...I wanted to get it fixed ****in the blink of an eye****.”

The literal base image is:

****blink = 快速眨一下眼睛****

But the whole expression means:

****in the blink of an eye = 快得像眨一次眼一樣；一瞬間 / 轉眼間****

So:

> ****get it fixed in the blink of an eye****

= ****希望一轉眼就把它修好 / 希望馬上修好****

This fits the larger contrast in the passage: the speaker wanted an ****instant solution****, while his grandfather taught him to slow down and do the repair properly.

For your database, I would count ****2 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****blink****:

1. ****close and open the eyes quickly****
2. ****a light/device repeatedly switches on and off****

I would merge noun ****a blink**** into #1, and keep ****in the blink of an eye, blink first, on the blink****, and ****blinker**** as fixed or family extensions rather than inflate the core count.